CHAPTER FOUR

DATA PRESENTATION AND DISCUSSION

4.1 Introduction

This chapter presents the analysis of data collected from the respondents through the use of structured questionnaires administered to two key groups: real estate agency practitioners and residents of Abeokuta, Ogun State. The aim is to assess quackery practice in estate agency within the study area. The analysis focuses on both the demographic characteristics of the respondents and their responses to the research questions.

Data were analyzed using descriptive statistical tools such as frequency counts and percentages, and the results are presented in tables for clarity. The findings are organized in line with the specific objectives and research questions of the study. This chapter also includes interpretations and discussions of the findings in relation to existing literature and the practical realities of real estate agency practice in Abeokuta.

4.2 Demographic Characteristics of Respondents

This section presents the socio-economic background of the respondents, divided into two categories: real estate agency practitioners and residents of Abeokuta. The demographic variables analyzed include gender, age, marital status, educational background, and years of experience in the real estate sector. The purpose of this analysis is to understand the background of the participants, which provides context for interpreting their responses in subsequent sections. Two separate tables are used to display the data for both groups accordingly.

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4.2.1 Demographic Characteristics of Real Estate Practitioners

The table below presents the demographic distribution of the 50 real estate practitioners who participated in the study, based on gender, age, marital status, educational background, and years of practice.

Table 4.1: Demographic Characteristics of Real Estate Practitioners

Variable	Category	Frequency	Percentage (%)
Gender	Male	26	52.0
	Female	24	48.0
Age	18–25 years	21	42.0
	26–35 years	13	26.0
	36–45 years	12	24.0
	46 years and above	4	8.0
Marital Status	Single	26	52.0
	Married	19	38.0
	Divorced	1	2.0
	Separated	2	4.0
	Widow/Widower	2	4.0
Education	PSLC	1	2.0
	SSCE	8	16.0
	OND/NCE	11	22.0
	B.Sc/HND	15	30.0
	M.Sc/M.Tech	9	18.0
	Ph.D	3	6.0
	Others	3	6.0
Practice Years	1–5 years	20	40.0
	6–10 years	13	26.0
	11–15 years	10	20.0
	Above 15 years	7	14.0

Interpretation:

The data reveals that slightly more male practitioners (52%) participated in the survey compared to females (48%). The majority (42%) fall within the age range of 18–25 years, followed by 26–35 years (26%). In terms of marital status, more than half of the respondents were single (52%).

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The educational background shows a relatively high level of education, with 30% having B.Sc/HND and 22% with OND/NCE. Most practitioners (40%) have between 1–5 years of experience in the profession, indicating a relatively young and developing workforce.

4.2.2 Demographic Characteristics of Residents

This section presents the socio-economic profile of the 50 residents who responded to the questionnaire. The demographic variables covered include gender, age, marital status, educational background, and the number of years they have dealt with estate agents.

Table 4.2: Demographic Characteristics of Residents

Variable	Category	Frequency	Percentage (%)
Gender	Male	23	46.0
	Female	27	54.0
Age	18–25 years	15	30.0
	26–35 years	23	46.0
	36–45 years	8	16.0
	46 years and above	4	8.0
Marital Status	Single	14	28.0
	Married	24	48.0
	Divorced	4	8.0
	Separated	3	6.0
	Widow/Widower	5	10.0
Education	PSLC	2	4.0
	SSCE	5	10.0
	OND/NCE	17	34.0
	B.Sc/HND	9	18.0
	M.Sc/M.Tech	7	14.0
	Ph.D	7	14.0
	Others	3	6.0
Years Dealing with Agents	1–5 years	28	56.0
	6–10 years	13	26.0
	11–15 years	6	12.0
	Above 15 years	3	6.0

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Interpretation:

The demographic data indicate that the majority of the resident respondents were female (54%) and within the age range of 26–35 years (46%). Nearly half (48%) of them were married. Most of the residents held at least OND/NCE qualifications, with a notable number possessing B.Sc/HND and postgraduate degrees. Additionally, 56% of the respondents had been dealing with estate agents for between 1–5 years, suggesting substantial experience with the real estate market in the study area.

4.3 Presentation and Analysis Based on Research Questions

4.3.1 Research Question One:

Do individuals without formal training engage in real estate agency practice?

To address this research question, respondents who identified as real estate practitioners were asked whether they had received any formal training in estate management and valuation. The responses are summarized in the table below.

Table 4.3: Formal Training in Estate Management (Practitioners)

Response	Frequency	Percentage (%)
Yes	35	70.0
No	15	30.0
Total	**50**	**100.0**

Interpretation: The result reveals that while a majority of the respondents (70%) indicated they had formal training in estate management and valuation, a notable 30% admitted to practicing without any formal training. This indicates that a significant portion of individuals engaged in real

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estate agency in Abeokuta do so without the required professional background, highlighting the presence of quackery in the practice. This finding aligns with the first objective of the study, which seeks to identify individuals without formal training who engage in real estate agency practice in the study area.

.3.2 Research Question Two:

What are the main causes of quackery in estate agency practice in Abeokuta?

To understand why individuals choose to engage in real estate agency practice — whether formally or informally — respondents were asked to state their motivation for practicing estate agency. The responses are presented below.

Table 4.4: Motivation for Practicing Real Estate Agency

Motivation	**Frequency**	**Percentage (%)**
Self-employment	8	16.0
Nature of the job	9	18.0
Formal training acquired	7	14.0
To gain influence	8	16.0
Pressure from friends and relatives	8	16.0
Others	10	20.0
Total	**50**	**100.0**

Interpretation:

The data show a range of motivations behind individuals entering real estate agency practice. The most cited reason was “Others” (20%), which may include economic hardship, unemployment, or

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urban opportunities. This is closely followed by “Nature of the job” (18%) and a combination of “Self-employment”, “To gain influence”, and “Pressure from friends and relatives”, each with 16%. Interestingly, only 14% attributed their motivation to formal training acquired, suggesting that many practitioners may enter the field for personal or circumstantial reasons rather than professional ambition.

This supports the second objective of the study — to investigate the reasons for practicing real estate agency — and provides insight into the social and economic factors contributing to the rise of quack agents in the industry.

4.3.3 Research Question Three:

To what extent are residents in Abeokuta aware of qualified estate agents and their regulatory bodies?

To determine the level of public awareness, residents were asked whether they were aware that individuals without formal training engage in estate agency practice and whether they could differentiate between professional and unprofessional agents. The results are presented in the tables below.

Table 4.5: Awareness of Unqualified Estate Agents (Resident Q8)

Response	Frequency	Percentage (%)
Yes	45	90.0
No	5	10.0
Total	**50**	**100.0**

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Table 4.6: Ability to Identify Professional Agents (Resident Q10)

Response	Frequency	Percentage (%)
Yes	42	84.0
No	8	16.0
Total	**50**	**100.0**

Interpretation:

The data in Table 4.5 shows that a large majority of residents (90%) are aware that there are individuals without formal training who operate as estate agents, while only 10% are not aware. Table 4.6 further indicates that 84% of residents believe they can differentiate between professional and unprofessional estate agents, suggesting a generally high level of awareness among the public regarding qualifications and regulatory standards in the field.

These findings support the third objective of the study, which aims to evaluate the level of public awareness about qualified estate agents in Abeokuta. The high level of awareness observed may be attributed to prior personal experiences, media reports, or increasing exposure to real estate transactions within the urban setting.

4.3.4 Research Question Four:

What practical solutions can be implemented to curb quackery in estate agency in Abeokuta?

To assess the extent to which unprofessional estate agents are perceived as harmful or fraudulent, residents were asked two related questions. The first examined whether they believed such agents cause harm or engage in unethical practices, and the second assessed their belief in the prevalence of fraud among unqualified agents. The responses are summarized in the tables below.

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Table 4.7: Belief That Unprofessional Agents Cause Harm (Resident Q11)

Response	Frequency	Percentage (%)
Yes	43	86.0
No	7	14.0
Total	**50**	**100.0**

Table 4.8: Belief That Unprofessional Agents Engage in Fraud (Resident Q12)

Response	Frequency	Percentage (%)
Yes	40	80.0
No	10	20.0
Total	**50**	**100.0**

Interpretation:

As shown in Table 4.7, a large majority of residents (86%) believe that unprofessional real estate agents cause harm to clients or the profession, while only 14% disagree. Table 4.8 further reveals that 80% of respondents believe that such agents engage in fraudulent practices, indicating a significant level of public concern about quackery in the sector.

These findings provide strong support for the implementation of practical solutions aimed at eradicating quackery in estate agency practice. Such measures may include stricter regulatory enforcement, increased public sensitization, mandatory professional certification, and collaboration between professional bodies and law enforcement agencies. The results align with the fourth objective of the study, which seeks to recommend strategies for reducing or eliminating quackery in the real estate sector.

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4.4 Discussion of Findings

The findings from this study reveal that a significant number of individuals are practicing real estate agency in Abeokuta without formal training. Specifically, 30% of the real estate practitioners surveyed admitted to not having received any formal education in estate management and valuation. This aligns with the first research objective and confirms the concern that unqualified individuals, often referred to as quacks, are actively operating within the industry. This trend is worrisome as it poses a threat to the professionalism, integrity, and regulation of the estate agency practice in the study area.

The second objective aimed to identify the reasons why individuals venture into estate agency practice. The responses indicate that motivations vary widely. While some practitioners cited self-employment and the nature of the job as their primary motivations, others were driven by peer pressure or the opportunity to gain influence. Notably, only a few respondents credited their involvement to formal training. This suggests that economic and social factors, rather than professional qualifications or passion for the field, are the main drivers of participation in real estate agency. This finding supports prior studies which argue that lack of entry barriers contributes to the rise of quackery in the real estate sector.

Regarding the level of public awareness, the study found that a high percentage of residents are aware of the existence of unqualified estate agents. About 90% of respondents confirmed their awareness of individuals practicing without formal training, and 84% believed they could differentiate between professional and unprofessional agents. This indicates that the general public in Abeokuta is becoming more conscious of who is qualified to operate as an estate agent. This growing awareness may be the result of personal experiences with fraudulent agents, media

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exposure, or greater interaction with certified professionals. Such awareness is crucial for encouraging the demand for professional services and reducing the influence of quack agents.

Finally, the perception of harm and fraudulent activity associated with unqualified practitioners was strongly affirmed by the residents. A total of 86% believed that unprofessional agents cause harm to their clients, and 80% agreed that such agents engage in fraudulent practices. These perceptions validate the urgent need for regulatory action, public enlightenment, and professional accountability in the sector. The findings suggest that the public is not only aware of the risks posed by quackery but also supports practical efforts to curb its spread. Therefore, the results of this study provide a strong foundation for the development of policies and strategies aimed at improving the standard and integrity of estate agency practice in Abeokuta.

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CHAPTER FIVE

SUMMARY, CONCLUSION, AND RECOMMENDATIONS

5.1 Summary of Findings

This study assessed quackery practices in estate agency within Abeokuta, Ogun State, with particular attention to identifying unqualified individuals in the practice, understanding the motivations behind their involvement, evaluating public awareness, and proposing strategies for curbing quackery.

Findings from the study revealed that a significant proportion (30%) of real estate practitioners in Abeokuta engage in the practice without formal training in estate management or any recognized professional certification. This indicates a notable presence of unqualified individuals operating in the field. The study further identified various motivations for engaging in estate agency, with many practitioners citing reasons such as self-employment, the nature of the job, pressure from others, and personal gain. Surprisingly, only a few respondents attributed their involvement to formal training.

Additionally, the research revealed a high level of public awareness regarding the existence and operations of unqualified estate agents. A majority of the resident respondents (90%) were aware that such individuals exist, and 84% believed they could distinguish between professional and unprofessional agents. This suggests that the public is increasingly conscious of professionalism in the estate agency field.

Finally, the findings demonstrated strong public concern over the activities of unqualified agents. Most residents (86%) believed that unprofessional agents cause harm, and 80% confirmed that

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these individuals engage in fraudulent practices. These outcomes indicate that the public not only recognizes the problem but also acknowledges the need for reforms and practical solutions to reduce or eliminate quackery in the profession.

5.2 Conclusion

The study has critically examined the prevalence and impact of quackery in estate agency practice in Abeokuta, Ogun State. Based on data collected from both practitioners and residents, it is evident that quackery remains a serious challenge to the professionalism and integrity of the real estate sector. The findings revealed that a notable number of individuals engage in estate agency without formal training or professional certification, often driven by socio-economic factors such as unemployment, peer pressure, and the appeal of self-employment.

Moreover, the study highlighted a high level of public awareness regarding the presence and activities of unqualified agents. This awareness, however, has not completely shielded residents from falling victim to fraudulent and harmful practices. The general consensus among respondents supports the view that unqualified agents pose significant risks to clients and the reputation of the profession as a whole.

In conclusion, addressing the issue of quackery in estate agency requires a multifaceted approach involving regulatory enforcement, public education, and capacity building. Without concerted efforts to professionalize the practice and eliminate illegal participation, the real estate sector in Abeokuta and similar regions may continue to suffer setbacks in quality, trust, and effectiveness.

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5.3 Recommendations

Based on the findings and conclusions of this study, the following recommendations are proposed to reduce or eliminate quackery in estate agency practice in Abeokuta:

1. **Strengthen Regulatory Enforcement:** Professional bodies such as the Nigerian Institution of Estate Surveyors and Valuers (NIESV) and the Estate Surveyors and Valuers Registration Board of Nigeria (ESVARBON) should collaborate with government authorities to enforce existing regulations and laws. Frequent inspections and monitoring should be conducted to identify and sanction quacks.

2. **Public Sensitization and Education:** Awareness campaigns should be launched to educate the general public on the importance of hiring qualified and licensed estate agents. This can be achieved through media outlets, community engagements, and collaboration with local governments.

3. **Mandatory Licensing and Registration:** All practicing estate agents should be required to obtain formal training and register with recognized professional bodies. This will help distinguish qualified professionals from unqualified individuals and ensure better accountability in the sector.

4. **Encourage Professional Training:** Individuals interested in real estate agency should be encouraged to pursue formal education in estate management through polytechnics, universities, or accredited training programs. Scholarships and subsidies may also be introduced to support willing candidates.

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5. **Community-Based Reporting Systems:** A reporting mechanism should be established to allow victims or concerned citizens to report suspected cases of quackery. This will enhance public participation in regulating the profession and reduce the chances of unqualified individuals thriving unnoticed.

6. **Legal Reforms and Penalties:** The state government should review existing laws and introduce stricter penalties for those found guilty of fraudulent estate practices. This would serve as a deterrent to potential quacks and reinforce the credibility of the profession.

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